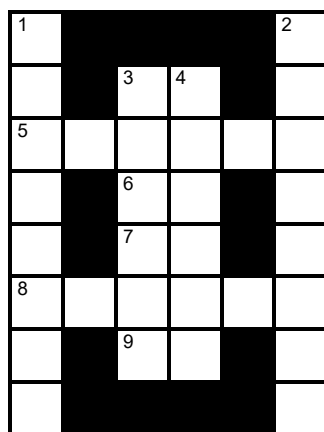




Across

3 Initials for the Celtics combo guard known both for his defensive tenacity and propensity to flop. (2)

5 Someone who loves to play ball, or a member of State Farm's fictional basketball family that has included Chris Paul and Damian Lillard (as a baby). (6)

6 Initials for both the point guard on the Lakers' bench and in the Suns' starting lineup. (2)

7 Beloved for his flashy scoring, the *answer* to this clue is the legendary Philly guard who averaged 6.2 assists per game for his career. (2)

8/1 One of several Thunder point guards on this season's roster--the one with a strong case to win Sixth Man of the Year. (6,8)

9 Initials for the forward who had two electrifying dunks in the 2011 Eastern Conference Finals opener, which turned out to be the peak for a *short-lived* Bulls run. Also the initials for the Wolves' "Googs". (2)

Down

1 See 8 Across

2 Dallas coach whose playing career was most similar to Ish Smith, per Basketball Reference. (8)

3 This year's rookie

phenom with razzle dazzle of the non-dunking variety (6)

4 When the *postseason* typically begins, accompanied by sprouting flowers and April showers. (6)